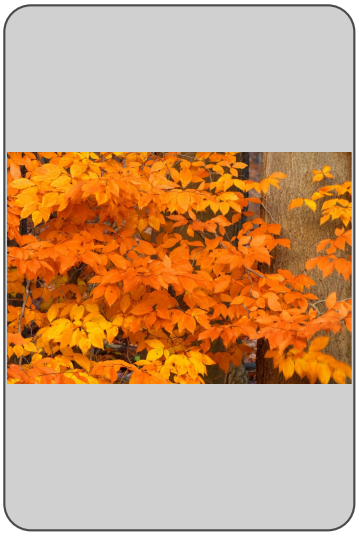
Fagus grandifolia
American Beech
Family: Fagaceae


HABIT


FALL


LEAF


BARK

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Deciduous large tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Slow
Size: 50–80 ft × 40–80 ft

Sun

Water

Soil
Deep rich moist well-drained preferred

Zone 8a
Excellent for Atlanta Zone 8a. Large native shade tree with smooth bark. Prefer full sun to part shade and deep rich moist well-drained soil. Golden-bronze fall color. Insignificant flowers and edible nuts. Moderate drought and clay tolerance. Prefer for shade or naturalize. Attracts wildlife. Extremely long-lived. Distinctive smooth gray bark. Eastern specialist. Forms colonies. Difficult to transplant.
Protect from wet soils and urban stress

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment
Plant in full sun to part shade, deep rich moist well-drained soil. Provide space. Golden-bronze fall color. Insignificant flowers and edible nuts. Mulch to retain moisture. Moderate drought and clay tolerance. Attracts wildlife. Extremely long-lived. Distinctive smooth gray bark. Eastern specialist. Forms colonies. Difficult to transplant.
Protect from wet soils and urban stress

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Eastern North America

Form
Upright-oval dense. American beech. Upright-oval dense. Large green leaves. Insignificant flowers. Golden-bronze fall color. Edible nuts. Smooth gray bark. Moderate drought and clay tolerance. Prefer for shade or naturalize. Attracts wildlife. Extremely long-lived. Distinctive smooth gray bark. Eastern specialist. Forms colonies. Difficult to transplant. Protect from wet soils and urban stress.
Also known as white beech. Sole North American beech species

Foliage
Large green leaves; golden-bronze fall color

Flowers and fruit
Insignificant; edible nuts

Bark
Smooth gray

HEALTH

Health
Susceptible to beech bark disease (beech scale + Neonectria fungi), which is established in North Carolina mountains and expanding; also beech leaf disease (nematode) is spreading in the eastern U.S. Woolly beech adelgid and leaf-feeding insects possible. Smooth bark is distinctive but vulnerable.
Non-toxic. Extremely long-lived when healthy

Symptoms
None stated